

## Contact

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wernerkruger888 (LinkedIn)

## Top Skills

Generative AI

Risk Management

Credit Risk

## Certifications

Nanodegree in AI Trading Strategies

Associate Professional Risk  
Manager (APRM)

Deep Learning Nanodegree

Executive Data Science  
Specialization

Introduction to Machine Learning  
with PyTorch

# Werner Kruger

Global Risk & Data Science Executive | Credit Risk, Fraud &  
Decision Systems | Former Global Head of Data Science (Banking) |  
AI-Driven Risk & Analytics Leadership

Eindhoven Area

## Summary

Strategic data and technology executive with nearly 30 years of experience building large-scale data, analytics, risk, and machine learning systems across fintech, banking, and high-growth startups. I specialize in turning complex business challenges into scalable, data-driven solutions — spanning greenfield ML platforms, credit underwriting, pricing systems, and enterprise analytics — that accelerate growth and enable high-velocity decision-making. Known for pairing deep technical expertise with sharp commercial judgment, I thrive where innovation and strategic execution meet.

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## Experience

### Empower (Tilt)

Head of Data Science, DataEng and MLEng

July 2025 - Present (1 year 1 month)

Leading the data function across Data Science, Data Engineering, and ML Engineering to build a modern data & AI platform for one of the fastest-growing consumer fintech products. Responsible for team leadership, technical architecture, long-term data strategy, ML operations, and delivering models and pipelines that directly support user growth, retention, and risk management.

### LawFi, Inc.

CDO, CTO | part of founding team

August 2022 - June 2025 (2 years 11 months)

Remote (The Netherlands)

Building the technology foundations to enable Legal Fee Financing, a unique offering enabling attorneys in Florida to offer credit to their customers. I am responsible for overall architecture, Loans Origination System, credit underwriting, data warehousing and integrations (open banking, credit bureaus, CRM and many more).

## BaadMay

Advisor: Risk and Data

March 2022 - June 2025 (3 years 4 months)

Exciting BNPL startup in Pakistan

## Bloom Group S.A.

Chief Data Officer | Part of the founding team

October 2019 - September 2022 (3 years)

London Area, United Kingdom

A core contributor to Bloom's founding team and Series A fundraising (including securing a £300M investment).

Impact:

- Built Bloom's Risk Engine, Decision Engine, Pricing Engine, and entire data platform from the ground up.
- Developed reporting capabilities, portfolio analytics, and monitoring infrastructure used by leadership and investors.
- Recruited and led a high-performing Data Engineering and Risk team.
- Established the operational frameworks needed to originate, assess, price, and monitor SME lending at scale.

Startup experience: full greenfield architecture, zero-to-one execution, and rapid scaling under high regulatory expectations.

## Klarna

VP of Data Science

January 2017 - September 2019 (2 years 9 months)

Stockholm, Sweden

Led a cross-functional organization of Data Science, Engineering, and Analytics teams responsible for building and maintaining Klarna's global risk platforms.

Responsibilities:

- Oversaw data infrastructure, real-time decision engines, bureau integrations, fraud modelling, and credit risk systems.
- Competence Lead for Data Science across multiple domains: Risk, Fraud, Consumer Analytics, Loyalty, Talent Acquisition, and Financial Forecasting.

- Drove strategic initiatives that improved decision accuracy, reduced fraud losses, and increased automation across markets.

Played a key role during Klarna's period of hyper-growth and international expansion.

## Standard Bank Group

10 years 11 months

### Group Head of Data Science

October 2015 - January 2017 (1 year 4 months)

Johannesburg Area, South Africa

Led the establishment and scaling of the bank's global data science and analytics function supporting enterprise credit risk, market risk, and regulatory capital analytics.

Specifically, I established the bank's first Data Science team and capability.

- Built the team, technology stack, project portfolio, and strategic roadmap.
- Delivered machine learning solutions for credit risk, customer analytics, fraud detection, and operational efficiency.
- Provided C-level leadership on data-driven transformation initiatives.
- Ensured enterprise-grade ML governance and data readiness across business units.

### Head Of Analytics (Global Markets)

January 2013 - September 2015 (2 years 9 months)

Johannesburg Area, South Africa

Led a team of analysts delivering analytics, BI solutions, and actionable insights for trading, sales, marketing, and senior leadership.

- Built BI infrastructure and dashboards supporting multi-billion-dollar markets activity.
- Advanced data governance and improved data quality across trading systems.
- Enabled more informed and timely commercial decisions through data automation and visualization.

### Head of Algorithmic Trading

January 2011 - December 2012 (2 years)

Johannesburg Area, South Africa

Led the buildout of Standard Bank's FX algorithmic trading capability.

- Reduced latency significantly across trading and pricing systems.
- Designed database architecture and wrote complex event processing code (CEP/ESP).
- Delivered production-grade systems for pricing, risk management, and execution.

#### Analyst Developer

March 2006 - December 2010 (4 years 10 months)

Johannesburg Area, South Africa

Designed and built Basel II regulatory capital calculation systems, ETL pipelines, and reporting infrastructure used across international operations. Ensured compliance with SARB, FSA (UK), and HKMA regulatory standards.

#### Growthlink Learning Technologies

##### Developer

January 2002 - March 2006 (4 years 3 months)

Pretoria Area, South Africa

#### Van Den Berg Accounting

##### Developer

January 1999 - December 2000 (2 years)

Malelane, South Africa

#### Deloitte & Touche Tax Technologies

##### Technology Support Specialist

June 1997 - December 1998 (1 year 7 months)

Nelspruit Area, South Africa

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## Education

#### University of Liverpool

MSc, Machine learning

#### University of Pretoria/Universiteit van Pretoria

BSc, Mathematics

#### Woolf

Master of Science, Artificial Intelligence